

March 12, 2026

Hiring Committee
GiveWell

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Researcher position at GiveWell. I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University and expect to complete my degree in May 2026. My academic training focuses on quantitative economic analysis, and I am particularly motivated by opportunities to apply rigorous research methods to questions that have meaningful real-world impact.

My research examines the dynamics of wealth inequality using heterogeneous-agent macroeconomic models that incorporate differences in returns to wealth and income risk. This work combines theoretical modeling with empirical calibration using microdata such as the Survey of Consumer Finances. Through this research I have developed strong experience analyzing complex datasets, constructing quantitative models, and synthesizing evidence to evaluate economic mechanisms and policy outcomes.

I am particularly drawn to GiveWell's mission of identifying highly cost-effective opportunities to improve global well-being. The organization's emphasis on careful empirical analysis, transparent reasoning, and clear communication aligns closely with how I approach research. I am especially interested in the challenge of evaluating interventions where evidence is incomplete, requiring a combination of empirical analysis, theoretical reasoning, and structured judgment.

In my academic work, I have regularly worked with large datasets and statistical software such as Python and Stata to conduct empirical analysis and simulation modeling. I also place strong emphasis on communicating technical results clearly so that they can inform decision-making by a broad audience. I would be excited to bring these analytical and communication skills to GiveWell's research process.

More broadly, I am motivated by the opportunity to contribute to work that directly improves people's lives. GiveWell's approach to evidence-based philanthropy—carefully analyzing data, quantifying uncertainty, and prioritizing interventions with the greatest expected impact—is a model for how rigorous analysis can inform better decisions. I would be honored to contribute to that mission.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards